6. **Obesity** - Excess body fat is associated with increased risk of developing hypertension, high cholesterol and diabetes.

7. **Hypertension / high blood pressure**- It is an independent risk factor for heart attack, stroke, diabetes and renal failure.

8. **Diabetes mellitus** - The risk for heart diseases doubles in individuals with diabetes.

9. **Smoking** - It is a major risk factor that damages the heart and blood vessels muscles directly by making the heart work faster and harder. It also increases the blood cholesterol and blood pressure.

10. **Physical inactivity** - Sedentary lifestyle leads to excess body fat, elevated cholesterol and high blood pressure resulting in 2 times increase in CVD.

11. **Stress**- Anxiety, depression and lack of social support not only increases the blood pressure but also damages the muscles of the heart.

DO YOU KNOW?

Heart disease occurs in person with diabetes at 2/4 times more than rate of the general population.

Blood lipids and CVD

Lipid is the class name for all fats and fat related components. Elevated blood lipids are associated with cardiovascular disease. Lipids substances involved in the disease process are cholesterol, triglycerides and lipoproteins- LDL (low density lipoproteins) and HDL (high density lipoproteins).

Cholesterol and triglycerides are the main forms of lipids in the blood. These come partly from the food and partly from the body's own production in the liver. Excess cholesterol above that needed by the body is deposited in the arteries and contributes to atherosclerosis.

Lipoproteins carry fat and cholesterol to the tissue for metabolism and back to the liver for excretion as needed.



"GOOD" Cholesterol - HDL

The HDL Cholesterol scrapes away necessary LDL from artery walls, preventing the formation of plaques. That's why HDL cholesterol is commonly called "GOOD".



"BAD" Cholesterol - LDL

LDL, on the contrary, deposits excess cholesterol on the artery walls, thus promoting plaque formation. For this reason, the LDL cholestrol is defined as "BAD"

Because LDL constantly sends cholesterol to the tissues and promotes the deposition in the arteries, it is called the " bad cholesterol". HDL called the "good cholesterol" transports cholesterol from the tissues to the liver for elimination from the body. It is not found in food but produced in the body.

High level of total LDL is a concern in the development and progression of heart diseases while an optimal level of HDL confers protection against heart diseases.

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